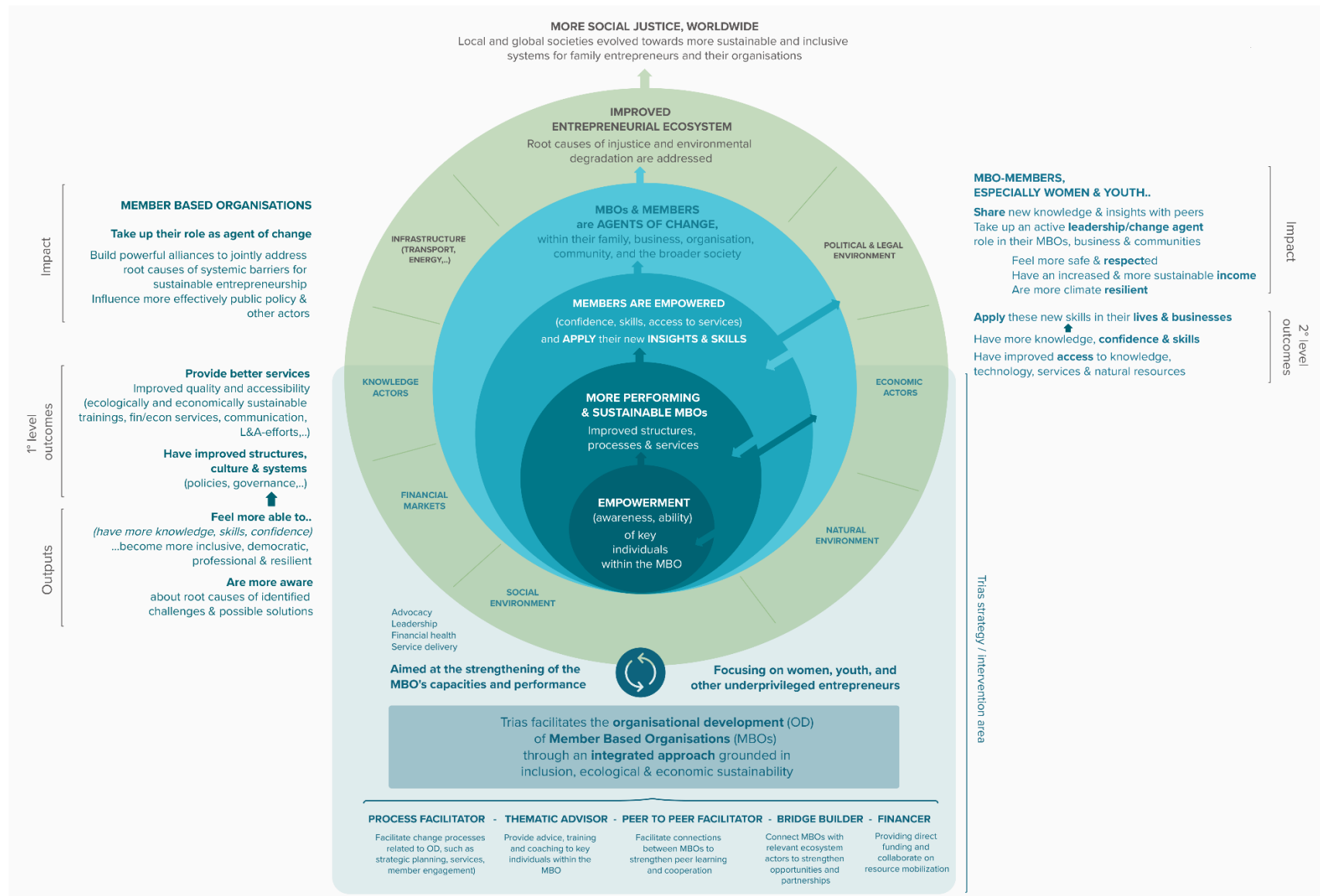


Theory of change

Trias DGD programme 2027 – 2031 in Brazil



1. Context and rationale of this programme (why?)

Looking at the world today, global commitments such as the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) provide a shared framework for inclusive and sustainable development in which no one is left behind. Yet we continue to face persistent structural inequalities, accelerating climate instability, and growing pressure on democratic systems and civic space. These dynamics disproportionately affect underprivileged groups, including women, youth, and economically disadvantaged entrepreneurs. Climate change and environmental degradation further limit their access to resources, livelihoods, and opportunities. Despite their crucial role in local economies, food systems and social cohesion, family entrepreneurs and their Member-Based Organisations (MBOs, our main partners) continue to face structural barriers in accessing markets, services, finance and decision-making.

Structural and Territorial Context in Brazil

Brazil is the world's seventh largest economy but remains highly unequal (Gini 52.9). The richest 10% hold 58% of national income, while the poorest 40% hold only 9% (World Bank, 2024). Multidimensional poverty affects 58 million people, concentrated in the North and Northeast (OPHI/UNDP, 2023). Inequalities are most acute in the Amazon bio-corridor and in large metropolitan areas of the South and Southeast, where environmental degradation, weak public services and social vulnerability intersect. In the Legal Amazon, over 80% of rural establishments are family-based farms, supplying most food to regional markets (IBGE, 2017), yet family farmers hold only 23% of agricultural land, while large-scale agribusiness dominates the remaining 77% (Agri Census, 2017).

Although agricultural productivity and market integration have improved, socioeconomic, political-institutional and environmental fragilities persist, disproportionately affecting women, young people, Indigenous peoples, Afro-Brazilian populations and other marginalised groups across rural-urban contexts.

Political and Institutional Environment

Following the January 2023 attacks on democratic institutions, Brazil has entered a phase of institutional reconstruction under President Lula da Silva, with renewed emphasis on social inclusion and environmental governance. Food security policies (Bolsa Família reaching 21 million households) and the re-establishment of the Ministry of Women signal a shift towards rights-based development. Nevertheless, large agribusiness cooperatives (OCB) dominate policy dialogue, while UNICOPAS organisations – family farming, waste pickers, solidarity economy – remain structurally disadvantaged, with weak representation of women and youth.

Economic Transformation, Digitalisation and Trade

While Brazil hosts advanced digital ecosystems in metropolitan areas (World Bank, 2024), over 50% of the rural population lacks proper internet access (IBGE, 2018), intensifying regional and social divides. Rural Amazonian territories and rural-urban areas face persistent digital divides, limited innovation ecosystems and weak connectivity, constraining productivity, competitiveness and access to emerging labour markets. Access to finance remains critical: only 15% of family farming units accessed subsidised credit (Agri Census, 2017). Women manage 30% of cooperatives but hold land parcels 50% smaller than those managed by men (IBGE, 2017). The informal economy employs 53.5% of workers, youth unemployment stands at 29.4%, and women represent 52.9% of the unemployed, carrying a triple workload of productive, domestic and unpaid care work (IBGE, 2024). New trade and regulatory frameworks –EU-Mercosur Agreement – create opportunities for sustainable business models but risk excluding small producers without adequate organisational and technical support.

Climate, Environment and Resilience

Brazil plays a pivotal role in global climate and biodiversity agendas. The Amazon stores an estimated 150–200 billion tonnes of carbon (IPCC, 2022). Deforestation reached 9,001 km² in 2023 – 22% lower than 2022 but still significantly above pre-2019 levels (INPE, 2024). In 2024, Brazil registered 1.12 million internal

climate-related displacements, the highest ever recorded (IDMC, 2025), affecting rural livelihoods and urban infrastructure. The National Bioeconomy Plan (2026-2035) emphasises the urgency of supporting traditional peoples and local communities as stewards of biodiversity (MMA, 2026).

Brazil has reaffirmed its **Nationally Determined Contributions (NDCs)** under the Paris Agreement, committing to reduce greenhouse gas emissions by **53% by 2030** compared to 2005 levels, and to achieve **zero illegal deforestation by 2028**. The Climate Policy Initiative (CPI, 2025) estimates that Brazil requires approximately **USD 200 billion** in climate finance by 2030 to meet its NDC targets, with a significant gap in reaching smallholder farmers and community-based enterprises. The absence of integrated, multi-stakeholder approaches—linking public authorities, civil society, academia, the private sector and blended finance mechanisms—hinders progress on climate resilience, deforestation control and value-chain decarbonisation.

Social Inequalities, Gender and Mobility

Women and young people in Northern Brazil, the Amazon and urban peripheries face structural barriers to economic participation, leadership, and access to productive assets. The Amazon region records a 19% increase in femicide in Pará and 36.8% higher incidence of sexual violence than the national average (FBSP, 2025). Rural women work 22.9 hours per week in household and care tasks, more than double the time spent by men (10.5 hours). Indigenous populations face poverty rates exceeding 60%, compared to 28% among white Brazilians (PNUD, 2024). Climate-induced displacement is an emerging challenge, requiring integrated responses linking adaptation, resilient livelihoods and human rights.

The programme focuses on transformative change – addressing root causes of inequality, exclusion and environmental degradation – rather than isolated or incremental adjustments. It recognises that durable change requires shifting power relations, institutional practices and cultural norms, not only improving service delivery or market access.

2. Trias' vision and long-term programme objectives (what for?)

A. Sustainable system changes for more social justice worldwide

More social justice, and a more equitable, sustainable and resilient living and working environment for family entrepreneurs worldwide, are the ultimate goals of this programme, the dream behind the broader strategy of Trias – and the driving force of many other organisations and individuals with whom Trias cooperates. We believe this can only be achieved when family entrepreneurs and their member-based organisations (MBOs) act as genuine change agents in their own ecosystems – their families, businesses, communities and country – and join forces with relevant actors to transform the root causes of inequality, power imbalances, poverty and environmental degradation.

In Brazil, this programme will contribute to greater economic stability, stronger climate resilience, and enhanced agency of women, youth and other under-represented entrepreneurs operating in highly vulnerable and informal contexts, as highlighted in the country's context analysis. Only then, they will be able to exploit their full entrepreneurial potential, and become successful leaders and entrepreneurs, seeing their productivity and income systematically and sustainably increased. This in turn will give these typically underprivileged entrepreneurs more strength and voice to jointly take steps in addressing remaining root causes of social injustice within their working and living environment.

At the broader societal and entrepreneurial ecosystem level, the programme aims to address structural root causes of social injustice and environmental degradation. It will contribute to: (i) **policy and governance** by strengthening MBO advocacy capacities, leading to greater inclusion of marginalised groups (family farmers, waste pickers, rural-urban producers) in public policies and government programmes; (ii) **partnerships and investment** by increasing public-private-academic partnerships for the Amazon bioeconomy and urban circular economy (notably in Pará, Rio de Janeiro and São Paulo), with MBO-led pilots in carbon markets and Payment for Environmental Services (PES) offering replicable models; and (iii) **climate action** by supporting measurable contributions to the NDC/Climate Goals of Pará, Rio de Janeiro and São Paulo, particularly in deforestation control, carbon markets and PES, through

technical advisory on climate finance, blended mechanisms and monitoring methodologies (Building Resilience I/II, SEA tools).

B. ... with a clear and integrated focus on three main strategic priorities

In everything we do as Trias, we put on three strategic lenses:

- ❖ *Economic Development* - Aiming at a more inclusive business-enabling environment, Trias focuses on both business development and market access, paying specific attention to production and profits, value chain development, marketing, the regulatory environment, and access to equitable financial services, research and technology.
- ❖ *Inclusion & Human rights* - Trias strategically focuses on women, youth and other underrepresented groups, looking at these groups from an intersectional perspective. We aim at transforming power relations and addressing structural barriers, in line with the key components of a human-rights based approach such as equality, non-discrimination and meaningful participation.
- ❖ *Environment & Climate* - Trias focuses on both ecological sustainability and climate resilience: we aim at (i) making production systems and other economic activities more environmentally sustainable, and at (ii) strengthening the disaster- and climate change resilience of family entrepreneurs, both within the agricultural- and non-agricultural sectors.

C. ... as such contributing to a rich set of interconnected SDGs

Considering the overall vision, strategic priorities and outcome objectives highlighted above, this programme will contribute to multiple SDGs, with a particular focus on SDG 8 (Economic growth and decent work); SDG 5 (Gender equality) and SDG 13 (Climate action). As our strategic focus on sustainable entrepreneurship as a driver for social justice, we selected SDG 8 as the primary goal for Trias. With our explicit attention to women, youth and underprivileged people, contributing to the targets of SDGs related inequality (goals nr 5, 10, 16), with SDG 5 as the one that reflects best what we do with our MBO-partners. With our strategic focus on climate and environment, SDG 13 is a logic choice for our 3rd secondary SDG marking this programme.

In line with our reasoning to adopt an integrated approach to our 3 main strategic priorities, these SDGs are mutually reinforcing. Indeed, promoting inclusive economic development (SDG 8) cannot be achieved without addressing structural inequalities (SDG 5), while climate change (SDG 13) directly affects both economic opportunities (SDG 8) and social justice. Similarly, progress in sustainable agriculture and food systems (SDG 2) reinforces economic resilience (SDG 8), while reduced inequalities (SDG 10) and strong institutions (SDG 16) create the enabling environment for sustainable entrepreneurship. Therefore, we aim to significantly contribute to these other three SDGs (2, 10 and 16).

Recognising the importance of multi-stakeholder partnerships in tackling the local and global challenges of family entrepreneurs and their MBOs, Trias strategically chose to further invest in its roles as bridge builder and facilitator of exchanges with and between its MBO- and strategic partners (cfr section 3 below). This programme hence also explicitly contributes to SDG 17 ("Strengthen the means of implementation and revitalize the global partnership for sustainable development").

3. From our common dream to joint activities – and back

A. Our programme objectives at outcome level

The programme's Theory of Change addresses change across four interconnected dimensions: personal (empowerment and agency of women, youth and waste pickers), relational (trust and collaboration among MBOs, private sector and public authorities), cultural (shifting gender norms and social discrimination), and structural (inclusive policies, climate finance mechanisms and market systems).

As indicated above, Trias strongly believes in the collective power of entrepreneurial people worldwide as a key element in our strategy and Theory of Change. We therefore consider MBOs as our strategic means, and seeing them becoming stronger and more inclusive as our main intermediate objective to sustainably and efficiently take important steps forward towards more social justice worldwide; and to a more equitable, sustainable and resilient entrepreneurial ecosystem.

In Brazil, our vision is for the selected Member-Based Organisations (MBOs) – UNICAFES Pará, CSA Brasil, UNICATADORES, and UNICAFES Rondônia – to become economically viable, autonomous, inclusive and environmentally resilient institutions, effectively embedded in their entrepreneurial ecosystems and able to act as locally rooted change agents in support of their members and the societies in which they operate. Through our organisational strengthening and institutional development (OS/ID) approach, these MBOs will increase their capacity to exercise ownership over their development pathways, improve their economic and organisational performance, and promote inclusive and environmentally responsible practices that benefit their diverse memberships – including family farmers, waste pickers, rural/urban producers, women and youth.

Performing and sustainable MBOs

As Trias, we would like to see our MBO partners to promote equity and shared power by transforming norms, behaviours, and relationships within their organisation and broader ecosystem (People), strengthen sustainable and climate-resilient practices rooted in justice and local realities (Planet), and support fair, inclusive, and resilient economic models where underprivileged members can participate and benefit (Profit). For these MBOs to take up these roles and their responsibilities towards their members and the broader society more efficiently, sustainably and effectively, Trias aims at jointly increasing the organisational performance of our MBO-partners. This is about improving both: (i) the quality of structures, processes, policies, systems and services within an MBO; and (ii) the financial, social and environmental sustainability of the MBO as an organisation

We hereby focus on the main areas of organisational development: leadership & governance, financial management and -health, advocacy and service delivery; and paying specific attention to inclusion, environment/climate and economic viability as part of our integrated approach to Organisational Development. A key assumption in our Theory of change is that increased organisational performance of MBO-partners will not only enable and trigger them to take up their role as change agent, but that it also leads to...

The MBO's underprivileged members having improved knowledge, skills and access

Addressing the identified challenges and needs of the members of our partner-MBO's (as part of a strategic reflection exercise Trias can facilitate, if desired), Trias wishes to see their members, especially the female, young and other underprivileged members, to: (i) have increased awareness, skills and knowledge about eg the root causes of the challenges they face, their rights and possible role in addressing these challenges, how implicit power relations affect both their well-being and business, how they can push and support their organisation to grow professionally etc; (ii) have improved access to relevant knowledge, credit, supplier- and consumer markets, technology, services and natural resources. As a next step in our ToC, we would like to see that these members also take advantage of improved access to credit, that they put into practice new insights about eg business planning or agro-ecological production etc. In sum, we wish that these members also. Besides, to change their own behaviour within their families, businesses, organisation and community - ideally up to the level of becoming a true agent of change

More concretely, Trias Brazil, together with its MBO-partners, aims at achieving the following outcome objectives through this programme. The following data provides illustrative output indicators that may/will be included in section D.1 of the proposal. These indicators are aligned with the output objectives above and reflect the specific context of each MBO partner.

Key outcome (objective of the DGD programme): Trias and its partners—the MBOs, including cooperatives and other producer organisations—are better equipped to fulfil their role as agents of change and contribute to a more inclusive, sustainable and resilient entrepreneurial ecosystem in Brazil. This contributes directly

to **stability** by strengthening local economic development, building civil society capacity, and fostering inclusive governance for marginalised groups (waste pickers, family farmers, rural/urban producers). It equally contributes to **climate action** by embedding climate resilience as a core MBO function – through sustainable practices, climate risk management and access to PES/carbon markets – thereby strengthening adaptive capacity and contributing to more sustainable food systems and Brazil's NDC commitments.

This reflects a strategic shift from the previous DGD programme: from general capacity support towards embedding MBOs within entrepreneurial ecosystems where market functionality, financial sustainability, systemic influence and climate resilience are central. The rationale, co-creation process and lessons learned are detailed in [Sections C.3, E.3, E.6 and E.8](#).

*These outputs are part of our **zone of control**. Note that we consider both these outputs and the 1st outcome level (organisational performance) as part of what we call our '**zone of intervention**', in the sense that we actively work towards, and take responsibility for changes up to that level. The following impacts and effects of the programme are:*

❖ **At MBO level:**

- **Economic sustainability:** MBOs become sustainable commercial platforms with greater financial autonomy and negotiation capacity in differentiated markets, increasing own revenues from commercialisation, certification and consultancy services.
- **Climate resilience:** MBOs institutionalise climate risk management, develop environmental monitoring systems, access climate finance (PES, carbon markets), and become local references for climate adaptation and sustainable bioeconomy.
- **Inclusive governance:** MBOs consolidate inclusive governance with quotas and effective participation of women and youth at all decision-making levels, and are recognised as defenders of marginalised groups (waste pickers, women farmers, urban and rural producers), actively influencing public policies (PNAE, PAA, PNRS).

❖ **At Individual level:**

- **Economic well-being:** Members (FFEes and NFEes) achieve increased and more stable annual household income, with access to fair markets and long-term contracts, reduced dependence on intermediaries, and greater bargaining power. Women, young farmers and waste pickers access niche markets with higher added value (certified, organic, EUDR-compliant products).
- **Climate resilience and environmental benefits:** Members adopt climate-resilient practices (agroforestry, agroecological systems, low-carbon recycling), reducing productive losses caused by extreme events (droughts, floods). They gain access to alternative income sources through PES and carbon credits, contributing to improved food security and environmental quality.
- **Empowerment, inclusion and decent work:** Women and young people hold leadership positions in MBOs and the entrepreneurial ecosystem, with effective decision-making power. Increased self-esteem, economic autonomy and civic participation of historically excluded groups are achieved, alongside reduced gender and age discrimination in cooperatives and value chains, and improved decent working conditions for waste pickers, urban and rural producers.

All these outcomes, both at the level of the MBO (organisational performance) and the aimed-at changes at member level (increased awareness, skills and improved access, as well as behavioural change) are part of our zone of influence. Agency-related behavioural changes (members taking up their role as change agent) are part of our sphere of interest.

B. Empowered key individuals within MBOs as short-term results (outputs)

To sustainably improve the organisational performance of partner MBOs, Trias works with their structures and key individuals – staff, formal and informal leaders, and volunteers – to reinforce organisational capacity in leadership, finance, advocacy and service delivery, recognising that knowledge, leadership and innovation already exist within each organisation and context. The empowerment of these key individuals constitutes the short-term results (outputs) of the programme.

- ❖ **Output 1. Market access: MBOs enhance members' market access by promoting higher-quality, differentiated, and value-added products and services, contributing to sustainable and competitive businesses**
- ❖ **Output 2. Climate resilience: MBOs strengthen members' climate resilience by promoting the adoption of sustainable climate practices, effective risk management strategies, and influencing the stakeholders ecosystem.**
- ❖ **Output 3. Inclusion and leadership: MBOs strengthen economic inclusion and the leadership of women and young people as catalysts within the organisation and the wider ecosystem, through capacity building, effective participation, and expanded access to sustainable economic opportunities.**
- ❖ **Increased awareness:** Key individuals develop deeper understanding of structural challenges, rights, power relations, and opportunities for change. Examples: (i) Awareness of gender inequalities and the "triple workload" of women in waste picker cooperatives (UNICATADORES); (ii) Understanding of climate justice and differentiated impacts of climate change on Amazonian family farmers vs. rural-urban CSA producers; (iii) Recognition of the MBOs role as agents of systemic change beyond service delivery and credit provision; and (iv) Knowledge of EUDR requirements and their implications for cocoa and coffee value chains (adapted from the UNOCACE model in Ecuador).
- ❖ **Improved ability (skills, knowledge, confidence):** Key individuals acquire practical competencies to contribute to organisational growth. Examples: (i) Skills on business planning, financial management, traceability systems (EUDR), climate risk assessment (Building Resilience I/II), digital tools (AI mapping for waste pickers); (ii) Knowledge: Market analysis, certification processes (organic, fair trade), advocacy strategies (PNAE, PAA, PNRS), inclusive governance mechanisms (quotas, committees); (iii) Confidence on public speaking, negotiating with government officials, facilitating participatory workshops (SPIDER), and mentoring of young members.

C. A small note about the non-linearity and iterative processes feeding system change

The narrative in the above sections focuses and clarifies the meaning of the vertical, upward-going arrows in our ToC visual, showing the progression from member empowerment to organisational development and behavioural change at both the MBO and individual levels, and further toward the shared strategic mission—where Trias, MBOs, members, and other stakeholders act as agents of change by influencing others and addressing root causes within the ecosystem. We also wish to highlight the returning arrows, emphasizing that all these changes are actually non-linear and iterative. Since organizations are made up of people, empowered individuals play a key role in driving organizational empowerment and improved performance. Their growth feeds back into the MBO, reinforcing and accelerating the ongoing cycle of transformation.

D. Assumptions and risks related to these pathways

The pathway of change described above is based on several assumptions about the context, partners and enabling environment. These assumptions are rooted in Trias' two decades of experience in Brazil, lessons learned from the previous DGD cycle (2022-2026), the Mid-Term Evaluation (MTE) conducted in 2024, and the participative co-creation process with MBO partners carried out between November 2025 and April 2026.

Assumption 1: Ownership and local leadership. MBO leaders genuinely own the programme objectives and share Trias' vision of social justice, beyond a transactional or project-based relationship. Key risks include

high turnover of key individuals (notably in waste picker cooperatives) and limited self-sufficiency, as noted by the MTE. Mitigation: Trias will embed succession planning in MBO governance policies, train multiple individuals per MBO, establish knowledge management systems, and apply a tailored approach based on each MBO's maturity level, with progressive reduction of direct financial support as organisations strengthen their own service delivery.

Assumption 2: Institutionalisation of inclusion (women and youth). MBOs are expected to move beyond isolated projects and adopt systemic, institutional approaches to gender and youth inclusion, transforming their governance structures and service delivery. Risks include structural barriers (double workload, violence, low schooling, limited mobility) that limit participation, as well as persistent cultural and organisational barriers that diminish women's and youth's potential to contribute to cooperativism, as highlighted by the MTE. Mitigation measures include affirmative actions such as accessible schedules, transport support, childcare at events and safe spaces for women in waste picker cooperatives, combined with dedicated leadership programmes for women and youth, awareness campaigns to address sexism and resistance to female leadership, and the separate tracking of disaggregated indicators.

Assumption 3: Co-creation and equal partnerships. MBOs and Trias are expected to maintain a balanced, transparent and mutually accountable relationship, grounded in mutual trust and respect. The main risk is that power imbalances due to funding dependency. To mitigate, Trias will apply its Seven Partnership Commitments from the co-creation phase onward, use participatory SPIDER assessments to define joint priorities, ensure transparent communication of funding allocations, and maintain its role as facilitator, while ensuring that co-financing models reinforce mutual accountability.

Assumption 4: Public-private-academic partnerships are viable and sustained. The multi-stakeholder ecosystem is expected to remain willing and able to collaborate with MBOs on shared agendas such as bioeconomy, circular economy, climate and food systems. Risks include budget cuts or regulatory changes affecting public policies (PNAE, PAA and PNRS) due to political shifts. Mitigation measures include advocating for policy continuity through UNICOPAS and MBO networks, supporting MBOs to diversify income sources, engaging multiple government levels, and leveraging existing successful partnerships as models for expansion.

Assumption 5: Climate and environmental conditions do not catastrophically disrupt operations. While climate variability is expected, extreme events such as large-scale floods, droughts and fires are not assumed to completely undermine MBO operations or programme infrastructure. Risks include loss of crops, recycling stock, infrastructure and displacement of members. The MTE noted that in areas where deforestation has reached more than 80% of the Amazon rainforest, training alone is insufficient, and restoration projects are needed. To mitigate, Trias will develop contingency plans with the MBOs, diversify storage and logistics to reduce single points of failure, establish early warning systems and emergency protocols, integrate restoration initiatives into the climate strategy (UNICAFES Rondônia and Pará) with specialised partners.

Assumption 6: AI and digital transformation do not deepen exclusion. Digital and AI tools are expected to be introduced in ways that include, vulnerable groups such as rural Amazonian producers, waste pickers, urban youth and elderly members. Risks include lack of digital literacy and infrastructure, which excludes women, elderly, remote members and waste pickers with low schooling levels. Mitigation measures include integrating digital literacy programmes into capacity building, using simple low-bandwidth tools such as WhatsApp and voice messages for initial phases, promoting peer-to-peer digital mentoring, providing training for new skills, and advocating for social safeguards.

Assumption 7: Financial sustainability and resource mobilisation. MBOs are expected to progressively reduce dependency on DGD funding and develop diversified, sustainable revenue streams. Risks include continued reliance on external project funding; less than half of affiliated cooperatives paid monthly fees to UNICAFES Nacional (MTE). To mitigate, Trias will focus on strengthening service delivery as a revenue source, support the development of new business models, link to blended finance mechanisms, improve

fee collection through transparent communication of member value, and develop service packages that members perceive as valuable enough to pay for.

These assumptions will be reviewed annually through participatory SPIDER assessments and multi-stakeholder reflection workshops. When assumptions prove invalid or the context shifts significantly, the programme will adapt its strategy accordingly, ensuring that the Theory of Change remains a living framework for adaptive management.

4. Joining forces in Brazil to render the entrepreneurial ecosystem of our MBO-partners more equitable, sustainable and resilient

A. Our key partners in Brazil

Member-Based Organisations (MBOs) of smallholder farmers and non-farmer family entrepreneurs are our main partners to achieve our mission. At the same time, Trias strategically cooperates with and builds bridges between a broad range of other stakeholders within or linked to the MBOs' ecosystems, including public authorities, private sector actors, financial institutions, research organisations and civil society actors. All these are strategic and equal allies with whom we jointly contribute to more inclusive, sustainable and resilient societies.

Specifically for this programme, we will cooperate with four MBO partners, selected for their complementary maturity levels, territorial mandates, and thematic expertise, ensuring coverage across rural and urban contexts in Brazil.

- ❖ **UNICAFES Pará (National Union of Family Farming and Solidarity Economy Cooperatives):** Rural, 2nd level developing MBO (i.e., an organisation that brings together and supports first-level cooperatives or associations, rather than working directly with individual members, currently in a consolidation phase), acts as a strategic anchor for the Pan-Amazon bioeconomy, cooperativism model expansion, climate-resilient agriculture, and innovative finance mechanisms. It operates across 13 first-level cooperatives in Pará state, with special attention to Amazon sociobiodiversity products (açaí, cashew nuts, honey) and key commodities (cocoa and coffee, linked to Trias South America value chains in Peru and Ecuador).
- ❖ **CSA Brasil (Community-Supported Agriculture):** Rural-urban, 3rd level developing MBO (i.e., a national network that supports and represents first-level CSA initiatives across the country, rather than working directly with individual producers or consumers, currently in a consolidation phase). It serves as a national anchor for healthy food education, circular economy, rural/urban vulnerability and community-supported agriculture models. CSA Brasil represents 200 first-level CSA units across 19 Brazilian states, with a strategic emphasis on expanding the CSA model to the Northern region. The organisation is an active member of Urgenci, the international network of Community-Supported Agriculture, connecting Brazilian experiences to global learning and solidarity movements.
- ❖ **UNICATADORES (National Union of Waste Pickers of Brazil):** Urban, 3rd level mature MBO (i.e., a national federation that represents and supports waste picker cooperatives across the country, with consolidated governance structures and advocacy capacity). It serves as the national anchor for lobby and advocacy, leadership capacity building (with special attention to youth and women), digital connectivity, circular economy, and urban climate resilience. UNICATADORES represents 230 recycling cooperatives across 26 Brazilian states, bringing together approximately 50,000 organised waste pickers, of whom over 60% are women. The organisation is headquartered in São Paulo and maintains active policy dialogue through its participation in the Interministerial Committee for the Inclusion of Waste Pickers (CIISC) and the National Solid Waste Policy (PNRS) forums.
- ❖ **UNICAFES Rondônia (exit strategy in 2028):** Rural, 2nd level developing MBO (i.e., an organisation that supports and coordinates first-level cooperatives, currently in a consolidation phase), anchoring the Pan-Amazon bioeconomy in Rondônia state across three strategic areas: **cooperativism expansion** (strengthening governance and member services), **climate-resilient**

agriculture (agroecological and agroforestry practices), and **innovative finance** (blended finance, PES, carbon markets). It supports 15 first-level cooperatives, focusing on Amazon sociobiodiversity products (açai, cashew nuts, honey) and key commodities (cocoa and coffee, linked to Peru and Ecuador). A gradual two-year exit transition is foreseen, consolidating complementary opportunities (IKI, GIZ, MDA) and supporting Trias in strengthening Amazon cooperativism.

The **selected MBOs** represent a **balanced mix of maturity levels, territorial mandates, and competencies**, ensuring coverage across rural-urban contexts. In addition, Trias will tailor its role according to each MBOs needs and lessons learned. For third-level MBOs, this includes facilitating strategic themes at the corporate level, building partnerships, and identifying complementary funding opportunities. For first-level MBOs, Trias will focus on advising pilot initiatives and supporting the upscaling of successful practices.

Two mature 3rd level MBOs from the previous DGD cycle – Cresol and UNICAFES National – will continue as strategic, equal partners in this programme, contributing to fundraising, knowledge sharing and advocacy. Regarding UNICAFES Rondônia, the exit strategy is gradual: it will remain an operational partner for two more years (2027-2028) before transitioning to a strategic partnership role.

B. Complementary roles and mutual responsibilities

Anchored in the **Trias 7 Commitments – Local Voices, Global Impact**, the Brazil 2027–2031 programme adopts a **coalition-driven development model**, co-created with its MBO partners (**UNICAFES Pará**, **UNICAFES Rondônia**, **CSA Brasil**, and **UNICATADORES**). In this model, **strategic stakeholder ecosystems**—public, private, academic, civil society and multilateral—are **central** to achieving scale, sustainability, and systemic change. Building these ecosystems represents a **major strategic shift** from the 2022–2026 programme, requiring increased investment by Trias SAM and Brazil to reinforce multi-level networks (local → state → national → regional → international). This approach is fully aligned with the Trias Theory of Change.

Trias will, together with its MBO partners, build an ecosystem of collaboration with strategic stakeholders from national and international levels. Especially with the 3rd level MBOs, Trias will dedicate efforts on building bridges and networking, leveraging their maturity and systemic influence. In collaboration with Brazilian partners and the Trias South America network, the programme will strengthen and diversify partnerships across the following stakeholder categories:

❖ Private Sector – Engines for inclusive and climate-smart market transformation, addressing value chain gaps and promoting sustainability

Trias engages with private partners to address market gaps and make value chains more sustainable and inclusive. Two strategic partnerships are established: with **Colruyt Group** (beekeeping project strengthening youth employability) and with **Suzano** (sociobiodiversity, climate innovation and Amazon bioeconomy, contributing to ESG/CSR commitments). Trias also works with public authorities to unlock programmes, subsidies and technical assistance for family farming, waste pickers and the Amazon bioeconomy. Key partners include federal agencies (MDA, MAPA, APEX, SAF), state and municipal governments (Amazon, Northeast, São Paulo, Rio de Janeiro), and diplomatic channels (ABC, Itamaraty). Trias' role across both sectors is to facilitate dialogue, enable co-investment and blended finance, align MBO needs with policies (PNAE, PAA, PNRS), integrate MBO-led PES and carbon pilots into climate policies, and support UNICOPAS in replicating inclusive cooperative legislation.

❖ Academia – Research, Evidence and Innovation for Sustainable Systems

Trias partners with universities to generate evidence, measure impact and co-create innovative models that strengthen MBOs and their value chains. Key academic partners include UFOPA, UFPA, Unimontes and UFTO, with a focus on applied research in sociobiodiversity value chains, food systems and climate-resilient agriculture. Trias' role is to connect academic research to MBO needs, facilitate participatory research design, and support the translation of research findings into practical tools and methodologies that can be applied by family farmers, waste pickers, rural and urban producers.

❖ The "2.5 Sector" – Civil Society, Multilateral, and International Cooperation

Trias works with a broad range of partners to amplify MBOs' access to expertise, investment and diplomatic support. With civil society organisations (Projeto Saúde e Alegria - PSA, Cogejur), Trias focuses on climate adaptation, territorial governance and rights-based approaches. With multilateral partners (IDB, Cresol AgriAgency, CPI, AgriCord, GIZ, IKI, UNDP), Trias unlocks investment pipelines, technical expertise and cross-country innovation platforms for blended finance and Amazon climate solutions. With diplomatic actors (Belgian Embassy, Consulate, AWEX, Hub Brussels, FIT, Belgalux), Trias leverages joint missions, investment attraction and European private sector engagement. Trias' role across these partnerships is to act as a bridge-builder, connecting MBOs to relevant actors and translating cooperation into concrete opportunities for family farmers, waste pickers, rural and urban producers.

5. Monitoring, capitalization, and learning

The programme's Theory of Change (narrative and visual) was revised in 2025 to integrate key learnings from the mid-term evaluation of the previous DGD cycle (2022-2026). This revision placed greater emphasis on the entrepreneurial ecosystem, recognising it both as the context for change and as a strategic means to achieve our vision. Trias also deliberately expanded its 'sphere of intervention' beyond its immediate sphere of control, aiming to strengthen the institutionalisation of knowledge and skills into MBO structures, policies and services.

In Brazil, Trias will deploy a comprehensive monitoring system designed to track progress and support adaptive management across three interconnected levels: MBO capacity (through SPIDER assessments), MBO performance (covering service delivery, market access, inclusion and climate resilience), and member-level changes (using quantitative indicators outlined in section D.1, complemented by qualitative tools such as outcome harvesting, timeline exercises and contribution analysis).

Drawing on lessons from the Mid-Term Evaluation (2024), the monitoring approach goes beyond compliance-based reporting to foster collective reflection and evidence-informed decision making. Disaggregated indicators (by gender, age and territory) are reinforced by focus group discussions, ensuring that the perspectives of women, youth and waste pickers are systematically captured.

The programme includes a baseline study (to be refined during the first year of implementation) and applies SPIDER assessments strategically throughout the cycle, while annual monitoring prioritises progress on concrete actions. A jointly developed learning and capitalisation plan, embedded within the broader cooperation plan between Trias and its partners, enables complementary partner-driven learning. Knowledge capitalisation occurs through structured partner dialogues, peer exchanges across the Trias South America network, and systematic documentation of good practices. This framework allows Trias and its partners to monitor, analyse and learn from both the activities and the intended and unintended effects of the programme at output, outcome and impact levels.

Monitoring distinguishes between change indicators (tracking shifts in context, such as policy changes or market access) and activity indicators (tracking implementation progress). Change indicators are reviewed through outcome harvesting and contribution analysis, helping the programme understand its contribution to systemic change beyond direct control.